ETCSL 2.2.2 — The lament for Urim (the Lament for Ur)

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (Black, Cunningham, Robson, Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006; composite after Civil 1989 (electronic), Vanstiphout 1998 (score) and Krecher 1996 (electronic); earlier editions listed in the XML header: Kramer 1940 (AS 12), Witzel 1945–46, Rosengarten 1971, Jacobsen 1987, Klein 1997 (COS 1, partial).
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.2.2.2 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.2.2.2 ; ORACC epsd2/literary **Q000379** (lemmatised, with morph: `../../ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000379--Lament-for-Ur/`).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-19 from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/`).
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Content

Eleven *kirugu* ("songs"), each closed by a *kirugu* rubric line and followed by a one- or two-line *ĝišgiĝal* ("antiphon"): (1) the gods abandon their cities and sanctuaries (1–37); (2) the refrain "O city, bitter is the lament" over Urim and the shrines of Sumer (38–74); (3–4) Ningal's lament: the storm, her flight, her pleas to An and Enlil, the irrevocable decision (75–170); (5) Enlil's storm (171–205); (6) the dead in the streets, the Elamites and Šimaški, Ningal leaves "like a bird" (206–252); (7) Ningal's lament over her house, her people led away, "a strange city built in place of my city" (253–329); (8) the poet addresses Ningal: "how do you exist?", the silent cult, "return!" (330–388); (9–10) the storm that knows no mother (389–418); (11) the prayer to Nanna for the restored city (419–438). Much of the text, especially Ningal's speeches, is in **Emesal** (the "fine tongue" of goddesses and of the *gala* lamentation priests).

Files

- `c.2.2.2.xml`, `t.2.2.2.xml` — ETCSL TEI source.
- `transliteration.md` (442 composite lines: 1–438 with 18A, 100A, 209A, 432A, which only some manuscripts have), `translation.md` — conversions by `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Manuscripts

About 90 OB tablets and fragments (Nibru, Urim, others; list in the XML header). Not in ETCSL: the manuscript evidence collected by Samet 2014 (see `../../_records-only--City-laments/`).

Line numbering

ETCSL composite = ORACC Q000379 = Kramer 1940 / Samet 2014 numbering (436 lines; ETCSL counts the *kirugu* and *ĝišgiĝal* rubrics as lines, as Kramer did). Lines with a letter (18A, 100A, 209A, 432A) are pluses of some manuscripts.

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for `קינות-על-ערים/1-הקינה-על-אור/`. ETCSL's English is rank 3; Kramer 1940 (`../../Kramer-1940--AS-12--Lamentation-over-Ur/`) is rank 5.